

VERSION 1.0 - PRODUCTION CANDIDATE

Arabic Workbook

العربية

Writing and pronunciation foundations, core grammar, 1,000 audited vocabulary entries, and 1,000 curated bilingual practice sentences with handwriting and retrieval space.

Foundations

Natural, idiomatic learner language takes priority over artificial uniqueness. Genuine homographs are retained when their learner meaning and grammatical role differ. A source-backed pronunciation key is taught in Foundations; sentence drills then use normal target-language spelling rather than inconsistent ad-hoc romanization.

Foundations

Target register: Modern Standard Arabic (MSA). These pages orient deliberate practice; the vocabulary and sentence sections provide the bulk of retrieval work.

Script / alphabet reference

ا ب ت ث ج ح خ د ذ ر ز س ش ص ض ط ظ ع غ ف ق ك ل م ن ه و ي

Use this as a compact reference, then practice connected words rather than isolated shapes alone.

Numbers 0-10

١٠ ٩ ٨ ٧ ٦ ٥ ٤ ٣ ٢ ١ ٠

صفر • واحد • اثنان • ثلاثة • أربعة • خمسة • ستة • سبعة • ثمانية • تسعة • عشرة

Writing system

Arabic is written from right to left. Most letters join within words and change shape by position. Move quickly from isolated letter recognition to connected-word practice.

Vowels

Long vowels are commonly written with و, ا, and ي. Short vowels may appear as diacritics in learner material but are often omitted in ordinary text, so context and morphology matter.

Definiteness

The definite article is ال. With sun letters, the /l/ assimilates in pronunciation while the spelling remains ال.

Gender and agreement

Nouns are grammatically masculine or feminine. Adjectives normally follow the noun and agree in gender, number, and definiteness; case is visible when endings are written.

Sentence patterns

Present-tense nominal sentences can link a subject and predicate without an overt equivalent of English 'is'. Verbal sentences use conjugated verbs with person, number, and gender distinctions.

Word order

Both verb-subject-object and subject-verb-object occur in MSA. Agreement behavior can differ depending on where a plural subject appears.

Handwriting warm-up

Copy five useful words from today's lesson, then write them again from memory.

Pronunciation quick-start

Broad Modern Standard Arabic (MSA) reference pronunciation. Educated formal speech varies regionally, especially for a few consonants, so the guide marks stable contrasts and notes major variation instead of pretending there is one accent-free phonetic realization.

Notation: slashes // show broad IPA phonemes or practical reference targets. They are more precise than English respellings but still do not encode every accent or connected-speech detail.

Vowel length

/a i u/ versus /aː iː uː/

Length is contrastive. A long vowel is not merely a more strongly stressed short vowel; sustain the vowel for longer while keeping its target quality.

Emphatic consonants

ص /sˤ/ • ض /dˤ/ • ط /tˤ/ • ظ /ðˤ/

These have secondary pharyngealization and can back nearby vowels. The careful MSA target for ط is /ðˤ/, while regional realizations may differ.

Pharyngeals

ح /ħ/ • ع /ʕ/

Keep ح distinct from ه /h/, and ع distinct from a vowel onset or ء /ʔ/. These sounds are formed with constriction in the pharyngeal region.

Dorsal fricatives

خ /x~χ/ • غ /ɣ~ʁ/

Use a fricative made far back in the mouth; exact velar/uvular realization varies without changing the spelling.

Qaf and hamza

ق /q/ • ء /ʔ/

These are broad careful MSA reference targets. Speakers may carry regional realizations into formal speech, so recognize variation without changing the written form.

Gemination

shadda ّ = consonant length

A consonant with shadda is held longer than its singleton counterpart. Consonant length can distinguish lexical or grammatical forms.

Sun-letter assimilation

ال + sun letter

Before a sun letter, the /l/ of the definite article assimilates in pronunciation and the following consonant is geminated; the spelling still keeps ال.

Short-vowel marks

fatha /a/ · kasra /i/ · damma /u/

Short-vowel diacritics are useful pronunciation aids but are commonly omitted in ordinary Arabic text. Learn the word form rather than guessing a short vowel from bare consonantal spelling.

Three-step pronunciation routine

1. First identify vowel length, emphatic/pharyngeal consonants, and any shadda before trying to read the whole word.
2. Read once slowly with those contrasts exaggerated slightly, then repeat at normal speed without changing the contrasts.
3. Treat the IPA here as a broad reference. For a new word whose vowels are not written, confirm the lexical pronunciation before drilling it repeatedly.

Sentence drills intentionally stay in normal target-language spelling: the pronunciation key supports decoding without creating dependence on ad-hoc romanization.

Sources, licensing, and QA scope

Vocabulary: drawn from this repository's canonical audited top-1,000 deck for the language. Repository source and audit records remain the source of truth.

Arabic and French sentences: quality-filtered from the ManyThings bilingual exports of the Tatoeba Project, with supplied sentence-level attribution retained under CC BY 2.0 France.

Urdu sentences: original controlled standard-Urdu learner sentences authored for this workbook from reviewed grammar-safe conversation families. They replace a rejected external candidate corpus that failed the release linguistic audit.

Quality scope: release gates check canonical dataset integrity, row counts, duplicate handling, script plausibility, sentence-type balance, source diversity where applicable, blocked Urdu legacy-error patterns, PDF structure, font embedding, and renderability. These checks materially reduce risk but do not substitute for independent native-speaker editorial certification; no absolute error-free claim is made.

Pronunciation foundations: broad-IPA and articulatory guidance was cross-checked against Karin C. Ryding, *A Reference Grammar of Modern Standard Arabic* (Cambridge University Press); Bernard Tranel, *The Sounds of French: An Introduction* (Cambridge University Press); Saleem et al., *Urdu Consonantal and Vocalic Sounds* (CRULP / Center for Language Engineering); and the Omniglot Urdu-script reference for Nastaliq, nūn ghunnah, and aspirated-letter conventions. These are broad learner reference targets, not a claim that each language has one accent-free phonetic realization.